

The Empower School Pupil Assessment Procedures



1. Introduction

At *The Empower School*, assessment is an integral part of our educational approach, ensuring that all young people make progress in their academic learning, personal development, and social-emotional well-being. Our assessment procedures provide a clear and measurable framework to track pupil progress, inform teaching strategies, and support each learner in achieving their potential.

Our academic curriculum covers English, Maths, Science, IT, Geography, History, PE, Aesthetic and Creative subjects, and PSHE. Each term, students will complete an ASDAN (**Award Scheme Development and Accreditation Network**) award as part of a project-based learning approach. All projects will be delivered exclusively by staff at The Empower School at our main premises:

Premises Details: Poltimore House, Poltimore, Exeter EX4 0AU, UK

Additionally, Kip McGrath, an Ofsted-registered and approved provider, will offer weekly supplementary support in Maths and English. While they will not follow the national curriculum, they will provide targeted reinforcement for students needing extra support in these core subjects. These lessons will be delivered by Ofsted-registered tutors from Kip McGrath, with additional support from Empower School staff. This will be hired for our sole use during our time here.

Premises Details: Kip McGrath Exeter East, 45-47 Fore Street, Heavitree, Exeter, EX1 2QN

2. Assessment Principles

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Our approach to assessment is based on the following principles:

- **Baseline Assessment** – Establishing a clear starting point for each pupil from a social-emotional and academic standpoint.
- **Formative Assessment** – Ongoing assessments to adapt teaching and learning.
- **Summative Assessment** – Measuring progress at key points during the academic terms.
- **Holistic Evaluation** – Assessing both academic and social-emotional development.
- **Personalised Learning** – Using assessment data to tailor individual learning plans.
- **Compliance with ISS** – Meeting regulatory requirements for pupil progress tracking.

3. Types of Assessment

3.1 Baseline Assessment (Upon Entry)

All pupils complete an initial baseline assessment upon admission to *The Empower School*. This helps establish their starting points and informs personalised learning plans.

Baseline assessments include:

- **Social-Emotional Well-Being Review** – Assessments such as the SDQ.
- **SEMH Tracker Profile** – Observations of areas such as Emotional, social awareness, relationships. Independence, behaviour and mental health and wellbeing
- **Pupil Self-Assessment & Goal Setting** – Encouraging pupils to take ownership of their learning with areas such journaling, short- and long-term goals in the SEMH Tracker Profile and a Student voice form completed at the beginning of each term.

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Findings from the baseline assessment inform the Individual Learning Plan (ILP), which sets specific, measurable, achievable, relevant, and time-bound (SMART) targets for the pupil.

3.2 Formative Assessment (Ongoing Monitoring)

Staff will continuously assess pupils' progress through formative methods, ensuring that learning objectives are met and interventions implemented where necessary.

Formative assessment methods include:

- **Daily Observations** – Evaluating pupil participation, attendance, engagement, and understanding.
- **Marking & Feedback** – Providing written and verbal feedback from our independent school tutors across GCSE subjects.
- **SEMH Tracker Profile** – Weekly touchpoints with the pupil on these all areas including reflecting on progress made in short- and long-term goals.
- **Self and Peer Assessment** – Daily reflections by journaling and speaking on reflection and accountability
- **ASDAN Certifications– (Award Scheme Development and Accreditation Network)** Achieving certifications designed to help learners develop personal, social, and employability skills, focusing on practical learning and real-world applications and allowing them to achieve experience in English, Maths, Science, IT, Geography, History, PE, Aesthetic and Creative, PSHE.
- **Classroom Quizzes & Mini-Assessments** – Checking understanding in an informal manner.
- **Progress Review Meetings** – Regular meetings between staff, pupils, and parents/carers.

All lesson plans based on these assessments can be adapted based on context to support differentiated learning.

3.3 Summative Assessment (Mid or End of Term)

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Summative assessments provide **a structured evaluation** of pupil progress at key stages, including:

- **ASDAN Certifications– (Award Scheme Development and Accreditation Network)** Achieving certifications designed to help learners develop personal, social, and employability skills, focusing on practical learning and real-world applications and allowing them to achieve experience in English, Maths, Science, IT, Geography, History, PE, Aesthetic and Creative, PSHE.
- **Pupil Progress Reports** – A written report detailing academic and personal development across all areas by the pupil.
- **Student Voice/Exit Interviews**– Capturing pupil reflections at the end of their placement.
- **Parental/Local Authority/Multi Agency Feedback Meetings** – Sharing progress with parents, carers and any external agencies setting future goals.

Summative assessment data will be used to review and refine teaching strategies and intervention plans.

4. Recording & Reporting Progress

All assessment data is securely recorded and systematically reviewed to ensure compliance with ISS.

4.1 Individual Pupil Records

Each pupil has a digital and/or physical record containing:

- Baseline assessment results
- Ongoing formative assessment notes
- Summative assessment outcomes
- Staff feedback

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- Behaviour and engagement logs
- Parent/guardian communication records

4.2 Pupil Progress Reports

Reports are shared with:

- **Pupils**– Regular updates on academic and personal progress to demonstrate progress made.
- **Parents/Carers** – Regular updates on academic and personal progress.
- **Senior Leadership Team (SLT)** – Reviewing school-wide performance and planning interventions.

Assessment outcomes directly inform curriculum planning and pastoral support strategies.

5. Supporting Pupil Progress

Following assessments, additional support may be provided through:

- **Differentiated Learning Plans** – Tailoring teaching methods to individual needs.
- **1:1 Support & Interventions** – Targeted academic and emotional well-being support.
- **Personal Development Programs** – Focusing on resilience, confidence, and social skills.
- **External Specialist Referrals (if needed)** – Accessing additional services such as speech and language therapy or mental health support.

6. Ensuring Assessment Quality & Consistency

6.1 Internal Moderation

Regular internal moderation ensures that assessment standards are applied consistently across the school. This includes:

- Termly staff meetings to review assessment data
- Training for staff on effective assessment strategies

6.2 External Validation

Where appropriate, external professionals (such as **educational psychologists or assessment consultants**) review our assessment processes to ensure best practice.

6.3 Compliance with Independent School Standards (ISS)

The Empower School ensures that all assessments:

- Enable pupils to make progress over time
- Are used to inform and improve teaching strategies
- Provide clear and meaningful feedback to pupils and parents
- Meet the ISS expectations for pupil progress tracking and reporting

7. Conclusion

The *Pupil Assessment Procedures* at *The Empower School* are structured, evidence-based, and pupil-centred, ensuring that every student receives the support they need to succeed. These procedures meet the Independent School Standards (ISS), ensuring compliance and high-quality educational.